

festival

Mixed Music

DELHI Legendary vocalist Gana Saraswati Kishori Amonkar says, "When I sing, the stage transforms into a temple and I adorn my Lord with my musical notes. I shut myself out from the physical surroundings and immerse myself in my music. That is my bhakti." Experience that bhakti amidst trees and flowers under an open sky at Bhakti Utsav from April 11-13 at Nehru Park in Chanakyapuri.

Organised by Seher, each day of the festival starts with religious chants by Vipin Kumar Mishra and Siddhi Shankar from Bihar, Changanacherry Madhavan Namboodiri (Sopana Sangeet) and Sanskrit and Oriya chants by A. Maheshwar Rao. The festival's uniqueness is that it does not just focus on bhajans but presents different forms of music.

On the first day Javed Bashir from Pakistan will recite the mystic poetry of Bulleh Shah and Khwaja

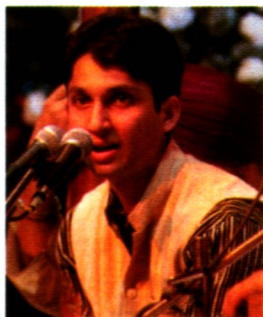
Ghulam while classical singer Padma Talwalakar, from the Jaipur Atrauli gharana, will present Marathi bhajans. Carnatic singer Bombay Jayashri will sing naama sankeertan and Pushkar Lele will perform sagun nirguna bhajans. Lele's voice is reminiscent of the legendary Kumar Gandharva's soothing and elevating style.

On the second day

Gokul Utsav Maharaj will present haveli sangeet and Hemant Chauhan will render Gujarati bhajans. Punjabi pop singer Hans Raj Hans, who

started singing after listening to a street singer, will sing Gurbani. The third day will have Hariharan—who was part of Colonial Cousins—presenting spiritual bhajans followed by Pandit Ramashreya Jha with the Ram Charit Manas in raag sangeet. The finalé will be Sufiana qawwali by Akhtar Sharif from Pakistan. Be there to enjoy the mystical bhakti experience.

by S. Sahaya Ranjit



MYSTICAL: Hans Raj Hans (left) and Jayashri; Lele (above)



exhibition

Imaginative Journeys

MUMBAI Pale Ancestors, a series of 48 watercolours by Atul Dodiya, is a body of work that transports the viewer onto a different plane—sometimes simple, sometimes elaborate. Born out of Dodiya's trip to Bali in 2005, the idea of Pale Ancestors is all paper with pale washes, recognised by an image and a word from the artist's personal memories and from images, moments and historical events. They are a significant departure from Dodiya's earlier works, since the imagery and language has changed. While there are references to his earlier collection, Bodywash, the new watercolours focus consistently on softer shades. The approach is minimalist with simple strokes that convey the complexity of the idea that they are drawn out from. At Bodhi Art, Kalaghoda, from April 8 to May 3.

by Swati Mathur

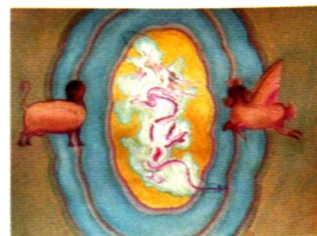
SIMPLE STROKES: Dodiya exploits his personal memories



art

Artistic Diversity

DELHI Mapping Memories: Painted Travelogues of China and Greece is an artistic journey across the shimmering blue of the Aegean Sea in Greece and the vast monochrome of the Gobi desert in China between May 2005 and November 2006 by Rameshwar Broota,



A travelogue impression Vasundhara Tiwari, Gargi Raina, Paramjit Singh, Gulam Shaikh, Neelima Shaikh, and Amit Ambalal. On at the Gallery Threshold at Lado Sarai.